Grading Rubric for NURSE-

N — Name the emotion

☐ Uses a direct "Emotion Word" or directly names the emotion

- *Clinician uses a specific descriptor (e.g., "sad," "angry," "frustrated").*
- *“You seem **anxious**.”*
- *"I can see that you are feeling **frustrated** with how long this is taking."*
- *"It sounds like you’re quite **worried** about the surgery."*

☐ Employs tentative "Softener" phrases:

- *"It sounds like," "I'm sensing," or "You seem" to propose an emotion*
- ***"It sounds like** you might be feeling a bit overwhelmed."*
- ***"I’m sensing** some hesitation or perhaps some anxiety about this plan."*

☐ Directly attributes/links emotion to a clinical event: Could be to a specific diagnosis or symptom.

- *"You seem **upset about these test results."***
- *"It’s natural to feel **scared when we talk about starting insulin."***

☐ Avoids judgmental adjectives: The clinician uses neutral or empathetic labels rather than pathologizing language.

- *"This sounds like a **difficult** situation to be in."*
- *"It’s **understandable** that you'd feel uneasy right now."*
- *“This sounds scary.”*

☐ Echoes/Mirroring: The clinician repeats the patient’s own emotional words to confirm they heard them. MUST SPECIFICALLY BE RELATED TO PAIN OR AN EMOTION ITSELF

- *Patient: "I'm overwhelmed." Clinician: "**Overwhelmed**, I hear that."*
- *Patient: "It’s all very confusing." Clinician: "**Confusing**, yes, there is a lot of information to take in."*

U — Understand the emotion

☐ Uses "Legitimation" phrases:

- *Explicitly states "It makes sense," "I can see why," or "That is understandable."*
- ***"It makes total sense** that you would feel that way."*
- ***"I can certainly see why** that would be a lot to handle."*

☐ Normalizes the reaction/response: Compares the patient's feeling to a broader human experience

- *"**Anyone** in your shoes would feel this way."*
- *"**Most people** in your situation would feel exactly the same."*

☐ Contextualizes the feeling (connects emotion to context): References the patient's specific history or timeline to justify the current emotion.

- *"**Given everything you've dealt with** this month, your reaction is very logical."*
- *"**Considering how much pain you've been in**, it's no wonder you're feeling low."*

☐ Provides a non-interruptive acknowledgment: The clinician allows the patient to finish their emotional expression before responding with validation.

- *"I hear you. Please, take your time... [Patient continues] ...I understand."*
- *"Mhm, I see. I'm listening... Thank you for sharing that with me."*

☐ Using patient-centered framing: Uses the patient's own logic to explain why the emotion "fits" the situation.

- ***"From what you've described**, it sounds like your frustration is really well-founded."*
- *"**Based on your experience last time**, I can see why you're feeling cautious."*

R — Respect the patient

☐ Labels/acknowledge a specific "Proactive" behavior: Commends the patient for a specific action

- *"**You did the right thing** by coming in."*

- *"**You've been very proactive** about tracking your blood pressure."*
- *"Im glad you have decided to…"*

☐ Acknowledges "Patient Burden": Recognizes the difficulty of the patient's tasks
- *"**I know how hard you've worked** on this diet."*
- *"**You've really put in the time** to follow this treatment plan."*

☐ Verbalizes appreciation for transparency: Explicitly thanks the patient for sharing difficult information.
- *"**I really appreciate you being so open** with me about your concerns."*
- *"**Thank you for being so honest** about the challenges you're facing at home."*

☐ Identifies internal resilience: Uses language that highlights the patient's character
- *"**You're being** very brave/strong/patient."*
- *"**You've handled this** with a lot of grace and patience."*

☐ Highlights the patient's "Value System" and frames them positively: Acknowledges what the patient cares about
- *"**It's clear how much** your family's well-being matters to you."*
- *"**That tells me** that you are doing your absolute best for your health."*

S — Support the patient

☐ Uses "Collaborative" / Inclusive language
- *Frequent use of "**We**," "**Us**," or "**Together**"*
- *"Let's figure this out as a **team**."*

☐ Explicitly states availability: Makes a verbal commitment to be there for future needs
- *"I will be here."*
- *"**Call me** anytime."*
- *"**Please call me** directly if your symptoms change at all."*

☐ Avoids empty reassurance, but signals continued prescence
- *"I can't promise it'll be easy, but I can promise support."*

- *You don't have to carry this alone; we're going to work through it together."*

☐ Commits to a Concrete Next Step: Offers a specific, immediate action to help
- *"I'll make sure the nurse gets that paperwork started."*
- ***I'm going to go talk to the pharmacist** right now to clear this up."*
- ***"I'll send that referral to the specialist** before you even leave today."*

☐ Verbalizes a "Joint Plan": The clinician explicitly links the next clinical step to the patient's input
- *"Based on what you've told me, **how do you feel about this next step**?"*
- ***Does this schedule work** for your lifestyle, or should we adjust it?"*
- ***"I'd like to suggest this treatment**, but I want to know what you think first."*

E — Explore the emotion

☐ Uses "Emotion-Seeking" prompts
- ***"Can you tell me more** about what's been on your mind?"*
- ***"Tell me more** about how you've been feeling lately."*
- *"What's that like for you?"*

☐ Explores the 'why' behind the feeling
- *"**What about this** feels the most frightening to you?"*
- ***"What is the biggest concern** you have when you think about the future?"*

☐ Explores "Functional/Life Impact": Asks how the emotion or worry is affecting the patient's day-to-day life or relationships.
- ***"How is this stress affecting** your sleep or your work?"*
- ***"Is this worry keeping you from** doing the things you usually enjoy?"*

☐ Encourages reflection rather than facts:
- ***"What's been the hardest part** of this journey for you, emotionally?"*
- ***"How has this been weighing** on your spirit lately?"*

☐ Keeps focus on emotion, not symptoms:

- *“When you think about this, **what feelings come up?**”*
- *"Moving past the physical pain for a moment, **what feelings come up** for you?"*
- *"When we talk about the diagnosis, **what is the main emotion** you're noticing?"*